

FAZAL ULLAH KHAN

Cyber Security Analyst | Microsoft Sentinel | Defender XDR | Incident Response | DFIR | Cloud Security

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Professional Summary

Cyber Security Analyst and Security Engineer with 13+ years of technology operations experience, built on a strong foundation in telco network operations, incident handling, RCA, escalation management, monitoring, and troubleshooting. Since 2023, I have transitioned into IT, cloud, and cybersecurity, with hands-on work across SOC monitoring, SIEM, EDR, incident response, threat hunting, endpoint security, cloud security, vulnerability assessment, digital forensics, and Microsoft security platforms. This background helps me approach cybersecurity investigations with strong operational discipline, evidence-based analysis, service impact awareness, and clear reporting.

Professional Experience

Cyber Security Analyst/Security Engineer AmaraTech IT Solutions

Jan 2026 - Present

- o Monitor, triage, and investigate security alerts across Microsoft Sentinel, Defender XDR, Purview, Intune, EDR, and SIEM platforms.
- o Analyse endpoint, identity, cloud, audit, and DLP events to identify suspicious activity, root cause, affected assets, and required remediation.
- o Investigate incidents in Defender XDR and Sentinel using alert timelines, device evidence, identity logs, audit records, and user activity.
- o Build and tune Sentinel KQL analytics rules for failed sign-ins, suspicious PowerShell activity, endpoint threats, Defender incidents, and data loss events.
- o Support endpoint security operations through Defender for Endpoint onboarding, device compliance checks, ASR rules, antivirus policies, and endpoint protection controls.
- o Review Purview security and compliance alerts covering DLP, sensitivity labels, insider risk, eDiscovery, audit, and communication compliance.
- o Create incident response workflows and automation playbooks to improve alert handling, SOC visibility, and notification processes.
- o Perform detection testing and attack simulation to validate alert logic, reduce false positives, and improve response readiness.
- o Prepare incident reports covering investigation findings, evidence, root cause, business impact, and practical remediation actions.
- o Support Azure and Microsoft 365 security hardening across identity, access control, monitoring, compliance, and secure configuration.
- o Perform web application security review and VAPT activities, including vulnerability validation, risk prioritisation, remediation guidance, and reporting.

Cloud Support and Security Engineer

Mar 2023 - Dec 2024

Cloud Hight Consulting / Generation Ireland

- o Designed secure AWS and Azure infrastructure and supported cloud deployments using Terraform, Ansible, Docker, Kubernetes, Bash, and PowerShell.
- o Developed cloud incident response playbooks and investigated anomalous endpoint, application, network, and cloud log activity.
- o Embedded DevSecOps controls in delivery workflows through SAST, container scanning, IaC scanning, and DAST practices.
- o Designed disaster recovery and resilience architectures using Terraform to support business continuity and secure service restoration.
- o Worked with engineering and DevOps stakeholders to improve security posture without losing operational practicality.

Cybersecurity Research, SOC and Investigation Projects

2025 - 2026

National College of Ireland

- o Conduct practical work across SOC monitoring, threat hunting, malware analysis, memory forensics, vulnerability assessment, and security reporting.
- o Use Sentinel, Defender XDR, Splunk, Wazuh, ELK, Wireshark, Suricata, and Snort in monitoring and investigation scenarios.
- o Automate selected triage and reporting activities using security automation workflows and scripting.

Network Operations and Security Enablement Foundation

2008 - 2023

Nokia, Huawei, TiGO/Millicom, ZTE and Partner Engagements

- o Provided consulting support in telecom network operations for 10+ years across the United Arab Emirates, Iraq, Pakistan, and multiple African countries.
- o Built deep experience in high-availability network operations, SLA-based incident handling, technical escalation, multi-source troubleshooting, and customer-facing issue management.
- o Worked in multi-vendor telecom environments with continuous monitoring, performance analysis, documentation, and

problem resolution across large operational systems.

- o This foundation supports strong incident response discipline, network security thinking, detection reasoning, and structured communication in cybersecurity roles.

Key Practical Achievements

- o Built practical Microsoft SOC scenarios covering Sentinel, Defender XDR, Purview, Intune, Entra ID, and endpoint security.
- o Created KQL-based analytics rules and validated detections through controlled lab activity.
- o Configured incident notification automation to support faster SOC awareness. Tested DLP, insider risk, eDiscovery, endpoint security, and Defender investigation workflows.
- o Produced technical and executive-level cyber incident reporting based on real-world OSINT case analysis.

Job Target

Target Roles

SOC Analyst Incident Response Analyst Cyber Security Analyst Digital Forensics / DFIR Cloud Security Analyst
Vulnerability / Pentest Analyst Information Security Analyst

Core Skills

- SOC Operations • Incident Response • Threat Hunting • SIEM • EDR • DFIR • Cloud Security
- KQL • VAPT • DevSecOps • Security Automation

Certifications

Current and Planned

- o Microsoft SC-200 Security Operations Analyst - in progress
- o CompTIA CySA+ and CompTIA PenTest+
- o AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner (Certified)
- o Cisco CyberOps - in progress

Microsoft Security Lab Focus

SC-200 Practical Work

- Sentinel analytics rules • KQL detection tuning • Defender XDR investigation • Endpoint onboarding
- Purview DLP and eDiscovery • Insider risk and compliance • Intune endpoint security • Automation playbooks

Selected Security Projects

POC LAB Microsoft Sentinel, Defender XDR, Purview and Intune

Detection Engineering, Incident Response and Compliance Monitoring

- o Built a Microsoft SOC lab using Sentinel, Defender XDR, Defender for Endpoint, Purview, Intune, Entra ID, and Log Analytics. Created and tested detections for failed sign-ins, suspicious PowerShell, endpoint alerts, Defender incidents, and DLP events.

Behavioural Anomaly Detection for Cybersecurity Using the BETH Dataset

Isolation Forest and AWS SIEM Integration

- o Designed an AWS-based anomaly detection pipeline using Isolation Forest and integrated results into SOC alerting workflows. Used Isolation Forest for unsupervised anomaly scoring and integrated the scored results into alerting and incident visibility workflows. Used AWS services including SageMaker, Lambda, S3, DynamoDB, Athena, and Security Hub.

Cyber Incident OSINT and Executive Reporting

Central Bank of Libya Cyber Incident Case Study

- o Analysed public cyber incident information using OSINT, threat intelligence, media reporting, and official statements. Prepared clear technical and executive-level reporting for SOC, CISO, CTO, and leadership audiences. Converted technical findings into clear investigation slides, response actions, and management-level recommendations.

AWS-Based Secure WordPress Deployment

Hardening, Monitoring and Vulnerability Mitigation

- o Completed a cloud security project focused on secure deployment, hardening decisions, vulnerability mitigation, and practical monitoring considerations.

SOC Home Lab, Wazuh SIEM and Investigation Scenarios

Detection Engineering and Response Practice

- o Built monitoring scenarios covering file integrity monitoring, brute-force detection, malware visibility, security automation, and analyst investigation steps.

Digital Forensics and Malware Analysis Exercises

Disk, Memory, Mobile and Network Evidence Workflows

- o Performed structured forensic and malware investigations using FTK Imager, Autopsy, Volatility, Wireshark, and related analysis tooling.

Additional Details

Work Permission and Languages

Full Irish work permission

Open to remote, hybrid and onsite roles

Languages: English, Urdu/Hindi